

NOVA'S HTML X-RAY CHEAT SHEET

Blueprint Thinking • Building Blocks • Layout & Nesting • Build Your Page

CORE MEMORY MAP

SKELETON → **SECTIONS** → **BLOCKS** → **NEST** → **BUILD**
OPEN → **CONTENT** → **CLOSE**

1. TAG ANATOMY

```
<p>Hello</p>
```

<p> opening tag • **p** tag name • **Hello** content • **</p>** closing tag • **/** closing marker. A tag is one marker; an element is the complete piece.

2. FULL HTML SKELETON

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<title>My Page</title>
</head>
<body>
<h1>Hello</h1>
</body>
</html>
```

DOCTYPE: modern HTML declaration, no closing tag. **html**: wraps document. **head**: setup/metadata. **title**: browser tab. **body**: visible content.

3. COMMON CONTENT TAGS

h1–h6 heading hierarchy • **p** paragraph • **a** link • **img** image • **ul** bulleted list • **ol** numbered list • **li** list item

4. ATTRIBUTES — name="value"

href link destination • **src** file/source • **alt** image description • **id** unique identifier. = connects name to value; quotes wrap the value.

5. LINKS + HASH NAVIGATION

```
<a href="about.html">About</a>
<a href="#about">Jump to About</a>
<section id="about">...</section>
```

Clickable content lives between a tags. **#about** targets **id="about"**. The names must match.

6. IMAGES

```

```

img is a void element: no closing `</img>`. `src` finds the image; `alt` describes it for accessibility/fallback.

7. LISTS

```
<ul>
<li>Coding</li>
<li>Skating</li>
</ul>
```

ul is the parent. **li** elements are children. Use **ol** for numbered lists.

8. NESTING RULES

Parent contains • **Child** is inside • **Siblings** share a parent. Indent children inward.

LAST OPENED → FIRST CLOSED.

```
Correct:
<section>
<p>Hello</p>
</section>
```

```
Broken:
<section>
<p>Hello
</section>
</p>
```

9. SEMANTIC PAGE MAP

```
body
■■■ header
■ ■■■ nav
■■■ main
■ ■■■ section
■■■ footer
```

header top/intro • **nav** navigation • **main** primary content • **section** grouped topic • **footer** ending/site info. Meaningful role? Use semantic. Generic grouping? Use `div`.

10. PAIRED VS VOID

Paired: p, h1, a, section — open + close.

Void: img — no closing tag.

11. SYMBOLS REFERENCE

< > tag boundaries • / closing marker • = connects attribute/value • " " wraps values • # targets an ID • indentation reveals structure.

12. HTML X-RAY DEBUG BOX

Missing closing tag	Every paired element needs its matching close.
Wrong nesting order	Last opened, first closed.
Forgotten quotes	Use attribute="value".
Wrong attribute	Links use href; images use src.
Image missing alt	Add a useful description.
List item outside list	li belongs inside ul or ol.
Visible content in head	Move visible content into body.
Duplicate/missing IDs	IDs should uniquely identify targets.
Broken hash target	href="#about" needs id="about".

13. VALIDATION CHECKLIST

■ Paired tags closed? ■ Nesting closes in reverse? ■ Visible content in body? ■ title in head?
■ Useful alt text? ■ Links point to real pages/IDs? ■ Indentation readable?

14. FULL VOCABULARY

HTML • element • tag • opening tag • closing tag • attribute • attribute value • browser • document • head • body • title • void element • parent • child • sibling • nesting • indentation • semantic • div • header • nav • main • section • footer • id • fragment/hash link

NOVA'S FINAL X-RAY

Can you point to the skeleton? Name each section? Identify each block? Trace the nesting? Then you are ready to build.